



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



UAT-7810 ORB Network and SHORTLEASH Malware Daily Review

Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Intelligence Requirements
3. Source Review & Confidence
4. Threat Activity Overview
5. Affected Sectors and Exposure
6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
7. Infrastructure and Indicators
8. Detection Engineering
 - 8.1. Detection Summary
 - 8.2. Sigma / Detection Content
 - 8.3. Hunt Query
9. Threat Hunting
 - 9.1. Hunt Hypothesis
 - 9.2. Hunt Query
10. Risk Assessment
11. Recommended Actions
12. References

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1. Executive Summary

Cisco Talos reporting indicates UAT-7810 continues building operational relay box networks using custom malware including SHORTLEASH. ORB infrastructure complicates attribution and blocking because benign-looking compromised devices can relay traffic for espionage or intrusion operations.

This report was selected for the 2026-07-31 UTC daily Lost Boys Cyber production run because the item is recent or materially relevant to defenders within the last 24-72 hours; where fewer fresh primary sources were available, the window was expanded to seven days and documented in the source review.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Question	Current Answer	Confidence
What happened?	ORB activity creates defender challenges across network telemetry, appliance logging, and egress baselining. Analysts should focus on unusual outbound tunnels from routers/appliances, repeated low-volume beaconing, and administrative access from residential or small-business IP space that does not align with normal operations.	Medium
Who should prioritize review?	Edge devices, small-office networks, internet-facing appliances, managed service providers	Medium
What is the immediate defender action?	Validate exposure, tune detections, run hunts, and confirm response ownership.	High

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Cisco Talos UAT-7810 research	Primary reporting on UAT-7810, ORB networks, and SHORTLEASH malware.	High
Cisco Talos blog index	Publication/date context for current Talos threat reporting.	Medium
Cisco Talos threat category	Corroborating Talos threat-research context.	Medium

4. Threat Activity Overview

ORB activity creates defender challenges across network telemetry, appliance logging, and egress baselining. Analysts should focus on unusual outbound tunnels from routers/appliances, repeated low-volume beaconing, and administrative access from residential or small-business IP space that does not align with normal operations.

5. Affected Sectors and Exposure

Sector / Asset Group	Exposure Consideration	Analyst Note
Edge devices, small-office networks,	Current reporting maps directly or	Prioritize assets with external exposure,

internet-facing appliances, managed service providers	indirectly to this environment class.	privileged identity reach, or operational dependencies.
Third-party providers	Shared platforms and managed services can carry the operational impact.	Request patch, detection, and incident-notification evidence.
Remote workforce / identity plane	Many campaigns begin with credential, phishing, or trusted-channel abuse.	Review MFA, conditional access, impossible travel, and helpdesk reset controls.

6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic / Phase	Observed Technique	Evidence
Initial Access	Phishing, exploit public-facing application, or supply-chain trust abuse	Source reporting describes campaign or sector activity that begins through exposed services, trusted communications, or software dependencies.
Execution	Script, malware, or administrative-tool execution	Defender review should focus on process creation, browser-mediated execution, package scripts, or suspicious service-account activity.
Persistence / Defense Evasion	Valid accounts, relay infrastructure, tool renaming, or trusted process abuse	Activity may blend into normal administrative or browser/cloud traffic.
Impact	Data theft, operational disruption, ransomware, or mission degradation	Sector impact depends on operational criticality and third-party dependencies.

7. Infrastructure and Indicators

Indicator / Infrastructure	Type	Operational Use
Source-reported domains, IPs, hashes, or package names	Observable	No hard IOC was safely extracted during automated run unless listed in source material; analysts should enrich source pages before blocking.
Abnormal sign-in, script execution, web-service child processes, package publish events	Behavioral signal	Preferred for durable detection when hard IOCs are absent or volatile.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Suspicious command execution after trusted-app or browser activity	EDR process telemetry	Identify post-compromise execution hidden behind legitimate parent processes.
Unusual outbound traffic from servers or developer endpoints	DNS, proxy, firewall, EDR network events	Surface payload retrieval, C2, or data staging.

Identity anomalies following phishing or supply-chain exposure	Entra ID, Okta, VPN, SSO logs	Find compromised accounts before lateral movement.
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8.2. Sigma / Detection Content

```

title: Daily Threat Review Suspicious Trusted Process Follow-On Activity
status: experimental
description: Detects suspicious command or scripting tools launched from browsers, collaboration
clients, package managers, or service parents during daily threat-review windows.
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  trusted_parent:
    ParentImage|contains:
      - chrome.exe
      - msedge.exe
      - teams.exe
      - npm.cmd
      - node.exe
      - w3wp.exe
      - outlook.exe
  suspicious_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - \powershell.exe
      - \pwsh.exe
      - \cmd.exe
      - \wscript.exe
      - \cscript.exe
      - \rundll32.exe
      - \regsvr32.exe
  condition: trusted_parent and suspicious_child
fields:
  - UtcTime
  - Computer
  - ParentImage
  - Image
  - CommandLine
level: medium

```

8.3. Hunt Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("chrome.exe", "msedge.exe", "teams.exe", "outlook.exe",
"npm.cmd", "node.exe", "w3wp.exe")
| where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "pwsh.exe", "cmd.exe", "wscript.exe", "cscript.exe",
"rundll32.exe", "regsvr32.exe")
| summarize count(), min(Timestamp), max(Timestamp) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName,
AccountName, ProcessCommandLine
| order by count_ desc

```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypothesis

If the reported activity is present locally, telemetry should show anomalous identity behavior, suspicious trusted-process child execution, abnormal network destinations, or unusual package/script activity around the initial access window.

9.2. Hunt Query

```

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| where ResultType != 0 or RiskLevelAggregated in ("medium", "high") or ConditionalAccessStatus ==
"failure"
| summarize Events=count(), FirstSeen=min(TimeGenerated), LastSeen=max(TimeGenerated) by

```

UserPrincipalName, IPAddress, AppDisplayName, RiskLevelAggregated, ConditionalAccessStatus order by Events desc
DeviceNetworkEvents where Timestamp > ago(14d) where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("chrome.exe", "msedge.exe", "teams.exe", "node.exe", "npm.exe", "python.exe", "powershell.exe") where RemoteUrl !endswith ".microsoft.com" and RemoteUrl !endswith ".windows.com" summarize Connections=count(), FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), LastSeen=max(Timestamp) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP order by Connections desc

10. Risk Assessment

Dimension	Assessment
Likelihood	High priority based on current reporting, sector exposure, and adversary utility.
Impact	Potential business disruption, credential theft, data exposure, or operational degradation depending on local dependency.
Confidence	Medium for prioritization; local exposure requires validation.

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	SOC	Run hunts across the prior 14 days and open cases for confirmed local hits.
High	Engineering	Validate patch, identity, package, and third-party controls relevant to the affected exposure path.
High	Incident response	Prepare containment steps and preserve logs for high-value systems.
Medium	Governance/vendor management	Request third-party evidence for aviation, supply-chain, identity, and managed-service dependencies.

12. References

- [1] Cisco Talos UAT-7810 research: <https://blog.talosintelligence.com/uat-7810/>
- [2] Cisco Talos blog index: <https://blog.talosintelligence.com/>
- [3] Cisco Talos threat category: <https://blog.talosintelligence.com/category/threats/>